

Guess the Sport! - An Idiom Quiz

Name: _____

Date: _____

Round 1 - Boxing

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
Throw in the towel	Give up	Boxing / Cricket / Golf / Sailing	Boxing
Below the belt	Unfair, cruel	Boxing / Football / Baseball / Cards	Boxing
On the ropes	In serious trouble, close to defeat	Boxing / Athletics / Golf / Cricket	Boxing
Saved by the bell	Rescued at the last possible moment	Boxing / Football / Sailing / Cards	Boxing
Roll with the punches	Adapt calmly to difficulties	Boxing / Baseball / Golf / Athletics	Boxing
Throw your hat in the ring	Announce you're entering a competition	Boxing / Cricket / Baseball / Football	Boxing

Round 2 - Football (soccer)

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
Move the goalposts	Unfairly change the rules partway through	Football / Golf / Cricket / Sailing	Football
An own goal	An action that accidentally harms your own side	Football / Boxing / Baseball / Cards	Football
A level playing field	A fair, equal situation for everyone	Football / Athletics / Golf / Cricket	Football
A game of two halves	A situation that changes completely partway through	Football / Boxing / Cricket / Baseball	Football

Round 3 - Cricket (very British - good one for this stay)

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
It's not cricket			Cricket

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
	It's not fair / not the right way to behave	Cricket / Football / Golf / Sailing	
A sticky wicket	A difficult, tricky situation	Cricket / Baseball / Athletics / Cards	Cricket
Bowled over	Extremely impressed or surprised	Cricket / Boxing / Football / Sailing	Cricket
Have a good innings	Have had a long, successful life or career	Cricket / Golf / Baseball / Athletics	Cricket
Stumped	Completely baffled, unable to answer	Cricket / Cards / Sailing / Football	Cricket

Round 4 - Baseball (American)

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
Step up to the plate	Take responsibility, rise to a challenge	Baseball / Boxing / Cricket / Golf	Baseball
Out of left field	Completely unexpected	Baseball / Sailing / Athletics / Cards	Baseball
Touch base	Make brief contact with someone	Baseball / Football / Cricket / Golf	Baseball
A ballpark figure	A rough estimate	Baseball / Golf / Athletics / Boxing	Baseball
A curveball	An unexpected difficulty or surprise	Baseball / Cricket / Sailing / Cards	Baseball

Round 5 - Golf

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
Par for the course	Exactly what you'd expect, typical	Golf / Cricket / Boxing / Sailing	Golf
A mulligan	An informal second chance	Golf / Baseball / Athletics / Cards	Golf
In the rough	In a difficult, messy situation	Golf / Football / Cricket / Boxing	Golf

Round 6 - Athletics / racing

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
Neck and neck	Very close in a competition	Athletics / Golf / Cricket / Cards	Athletics

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
Down to the wire	Not decided until the very last moment	Athletics / Baseball / Sailing / Football	Athletics
Jump the gun	Start or act too soon	Athletics / Boxing / Golf / Cricket	Athletics
Pass the baton	Hand over responsibility to someone else	Athletics / Football / Cards / Sailing	Athletics

Round 7 - Sailing

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
Know the ropes	Understand how to do something well	Sailing / Cricket / Golf / Cards	Sailing
Taken aback	Very surprised	Sailing / Baseball / Athletics / Boxing	Sailing
In the doldrums	Feeling inactive, stuck, or low	Sailing / Football / Golf / Cricket	Sailing

Round 8 - Cards / gambling

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
An ace up your sleeve	A hidden advantage kept in reserve	Cards / Tennis / Golf / Boxing	Cards
Call someone's bluff	Challenge someone to prove a claim you doubt	Cards / Cricket / Athletics / Sailing	Cards
The chips are down	The situation is serious, at a critical point	Cards / Baseball / Football / Golf	Cards

Bonus round - Chess

Since chess has its own rich vocabulary that's escaped into general English too:

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
Checkmate	A final, unbeatable move that ends the situation	Chess / Boxing / Cricket / Cards	Chess
A pawn in someone's game	Someone being used by others for their own purposes	Chess / Football / Golf / Cards	Chess
Your move	It's your turn to act or respond	Chess / Athletics / Sailing / Baseball	Chess
Stalemate			Chess

Idiom	Meaning	Options	Answer
	A situation where no side can make progress	Chess / Cricket / Boxing / Golf	

Trick question (mix in as a bonus/tiebreaker)

"Playing ball" (meaning to cooperate) – which sport? (*Baseball – not basketball, despite the name! "Play ball" is the umpire's call to start a baseball game.*)

If you want, I can also turn this into a plain text file formatted for direct copy-paste into Kahoot's or Wayground's question import tools – just let me know which platform and I'll match their format.

Guess the Sport! - An Idiom Quiz

How to run it

Read the idiom and its meaning, then give the 4 sport options. Teams/individuals guess before you reveal the answer. For Kahoot/Wayground, each row below is one question: the idiom+meaning is the question text, the 4 sports are the answer options, and the bolded one is correct.

About this activity

Format: idiom + meaning given, students guess the sport of origin. Ready to drop into Kahoot/Wayground as multiple choice, or run orally as a team game.